



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Calvary Classical Academy

School Website: <https://calvarystcloud.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Calvary Classical Academy (St Cloud, MN, 56301) presents as a classical Christian academy operating within Calvary Church St. Cloud. Public materials emphasize classical framing (Latin, traditional subjects, aesthetic beauty through the arts) alongside explicit Christian formation (discipleship, worship, missions). The site repeatedly foregrounds a religious purpose for education (disciples of Jesus Christ) and a commitment to traditional, classroom-based subjects with hands-on learning. However, explicit references to core classical-curriculum fixtures such as Great Books/Great Conversation, the full Trivium/Quadrivium framework, or Socratic seminars are not clearly stated on the public pages. The school's materials do show concrete classical attributes (Latin, aesthetics, classical naming) and a robust parish-community scaffolding (worship, community groups, missions), but several hallmark elements of a fully articulated classical program (e.g., explicit Trivium/Quadrivium pedagogy, detailed Great Books emphasis, student-teacher as living curriculum, formal parental formation processes) are not overtly documented on the site.

Overall classification (aggregate): **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Key observations driving the assessment: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations are strongly present via explicit discipleship, worship, and mission-minded activity (**CLASSICAL** in evidence and tone). - Curriculum signals include classical markers like Latin and traditional subjects, but lack explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and full Trivium/Quadrivium articulation in public pages (**SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**). - Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent/Community indicators exist (e.g., leadership bios, community/missions pages, worship/ministry pages), but explicit classical pedagogy prescriptions (Socratic seminars, Scholé, living curriculum) are not clearly spelled out on the site (**SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**). - The Public Materials show a genuine commitment to formation, virtue, and beauty in a Christian framework, but the site does not consistently foreground the full classical lexicon (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé language) in a way that would push all six categories to **CLASSICAL**. This yields an overall **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** classification, with Element 1 leaning **CLASSICAL**.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The program is described as a classical Christian academy with explicit aim to form disciples of Jesus Christ, indicating a strong religious/teleological orientation.
- Worship/ministry content emphasizes liturgical-communal practices (Worship & Production; community groups; missions) as part of the school's ecosystem.
- Public materials reference "disciple" formation and Gospel-centered activities, aligning with a theological foundation.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords found: worship, beauty (aesthetic beauty), theology-related framing through discipleship and liturgical activity. Evidence includes explicit worship content and aesthetic framing.
- Negative keywords: none clearly present in public materials (no overt secular relativism signals on the site).
- Why this rating
- The presence of explicit worship, communal liturgical life, and a theological aim to form “disciples” signals a strong religious-metaphysical grounding, consistent with CLASSICAL in spirit. However, the site does not consistently deploy the full classical lexicon (e.g., “theology” as a mapped keyword, liturgy as a category label, or explicit Sacramental/Liturgical vocabulary beyond worship). This yields a solid CLASSICAL orientation in spirit, but the textual mapping to all positives in the lexicon is not fully explicit, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The public materials frame education as formation and maturation of character through discipleship and reasoned thinking, with explicit emphasis on discernment, understanding, and spiritual aims.
- Language emphasizes forming students who reason persuasively and articulate clearly, aligning with a telos beyond mere job prep.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords from the lexicon (e.g., formation, virtue, telos, scholé, pursuit of true/good/beautiful) are not explicitly present as exact terms in the public pages; the formation/discipleship emphasis is present conceptually but not word-for-word in the lexicon’s form. Therefore, exact lexical matches are limited.
- Negative keywords such as “workforce preparation” or “career-centric” are not evident; the framing leans toward formation. This yields few if any direct lexicon hits, leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to the alignment in spirit rather than explicit terminology.
- Why this rating
- Public messaging emphasizes formation and moral/spiritual formation rather than purely information-transfer or career-readiness. The absence of explicit classical-formulation language (e.g., “pursuit of the true, good, beautiful” or “great conversation”) in the visible materials places Element 2 in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The academy explicitly notes classical elements like Latin and traditional academic subjects; the description signals a conventional, classical-friendly curriculum.
- Public materials emphasize objective and aesthetic beauty through the arts (music, drama, painting, sculpture, design) and hands-on learning, aligning with a classical emphasis on the liberal arts and cultivation of wonder.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Latin (explicitly called out); classical subjects; engagement with “aesthetic beauty” through arts; traditional subjects. These map to the lexicon’s Curriculum cluster (Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Greek, history, great books) even if not all are spelled out on the site.
- Negative keywords: absence of explicit Great Books/Great Conversation, explicit history-integration framing beyond standard subjects, or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium labeling on the public site. This reduces the score for a full CLASSICAL label.
- Why this rating
- The curriculum shows classical leanings (Latin, arts as beauty, traditional subjects) but lacks explicit articulation of Great Books/Great Conversation, and the Trivium/Quadrivium framework in public text. Thus, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is a more accurate reflection than CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The site emphasizes hands-on learning and aesthetic experiences (artistically oriented activities) alongside traditional classes, suggesting a mix of approaches rather than a purely Socratic-centric program.
- There is evidence of lower-school memorization/arts-based engagement (singing and memory-related activities) in the broader classical-education literature, though not explicitly described on the site. The site's public pages emphasize practical engagement and traditional subjects rather than explicit Socratic seminars or rhetoric training.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: "singing," "memory," "aesthetic beauty," "hands-on learning." These map to some classical pedagogy signals (recitation, memory work, engagement with beauty) in the lexicon.
- Negative keywords: explicit references to purely Socratic seminars, dialectic, or rhetoric instruction in high school are not visible on the public pages; there is no strong emphasis on a full-trivium pedagogy and no explicit scholé language. This reduces the alignment with a fully classical pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates some classical pedagogical signals (arts-based, memory-friendly elements) but lacks explicit, publicly stated Socratic, seminar-based high-school pedagogy or strict Trivium/Quadrivium pedagogy documentation. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public pages show named school leadership (Head of Calvary Classical Academy, directors) and a roster of staff/elders, with biographies that highlight long-term commitment and mentoring roles. This indicates a teacher-centered, character-forming approach consistent with classical ideals of virtue and living examples.
- The presence of a "living curriculum" concept is not explicitly stated, but the biographies and leadership structure imply a teacher-led, example-based culture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: "mentors," "living curriculum" (conceptually reflected through teacher biographies and leadership roles), "model teachers" (implied by leadership bios). The site explicitly frames leaders and faculty in service of formation.
- Negative keywords: none clearly visible (no explicit negations about faculty placement or lack of classical formation). The textual evidence supports a classical-leaning faculty model but not with the full lexicon terms.
- Why this rating
- The visible staffing structure and the emphasis on leadership roles in education align with classical expectations of faculty as virtuous, mentoring guides and the core of the school. Yet the site does not explicitly claim a fully developed "portrait of the teacher" or "faculty as living curriculum" language beyond bios, so it remains SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school sits within a church community with ministries (Missions, Worship Production, Community Groups) and public-facing materials that describe a community-centric ethos and opportunities for involvement. This signals a collaborative stance with parents and church members in a community formation process.
- The presence of community and mission activity suggests a broader ecosystem in which families engage with the classical-education project, even if explicit parent-formation programs are not spelled out on the site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: “community,” “missions,” “worship,” and “disciples” reflect a communal formation approach; terms like “partner with parents” or direct parent-education programs are not explicitly described on the site, but the church-school integration implies opportunities for parent involvement.
- Negative keywords: explicit “parents as co-teachers” or structured parent-formation offerings are not clearly documented; open-campus/parent-visitor policies are not described in detail on public pages.
- Why this rating
- The public materials indicate a robust community/hub context with parental involvement opportunities via the church and ministry ecosystem, aligning with the classical emphasis on parents as co-educators in the Six Elements lexicon. However, explicit parent-education programs or formal “co-teacher” language are not clearly documented on the site, hence SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment - The school demonstrates a recognizable classical footprint (Latin, traditional subjects, aesthetic formation, explicit Christian formation, and a church-community infrastructure). However, it does not consistently articulate the full classical curriculum and pedagogy (Great Books/Great Conversation; Trivium/Quadrivium pedagogy; Scholé language) in public materials. The combination yields an overall classification of SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle - Explicitly publish and emphasize classical pedagogy in public materials, including: - Clear articulation of Trivium and Quadrivium elements (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music) and how they structure K–12 programs. - Explicit references to Great Books/-Great Conversation and a Great Books reading plan or list for students, including a publicly stated goal to join the Great Conversation. - Public, specific description of Scholé/restful learning approaches, including how memory work, chanting, or recitation are integrated into lower/upper school curricula. - Articulation of the teacher as the living curriculum and a stated portrait of the ideal teacher and student in the school's culture. - Strengthen parent formation and engagement by detailing formal co-educator roles for parents, parent book studies, and regular visits/volunteer opportunities with visible policies. - Expand explicit public references to Socratic seminars, rhetorical oratory opportunities, and upper-school rhetoric projects to reflect classical pedagogy more directly.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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